

ELECTRONICS MANUFACTURING SERVICE PROVIDER Is A Partner Not A Vendor

With the outsourced manufacturing becoming a norm in electronics product manufacturing, one of the key aspects that needs to be addressed is the choice of electronics manufacturing service (EMS) provider. When an OEM looks for outsourcing their manufacturing, deciding what to outsource is only 50% of the solution and the other 50% is to decide whom to outsource to.

This step is always a challenge. One wrong move at this stage destroys the relationship with their client and the business for the OEMs



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Most of the times lower cost seems to be the primary driver for selecting the EMS partner. But this can be risky as a successful EMS partnership is based on much more than the cost alone. The best way to assess an EMS partner is to do a capability map exercise, which is basically assessing the processes involved around the manufacturing and see mutually where

the OEM and the different EMS partners stand. This helps the OEM to take a considered decision based on facts and capabilities and not based on cost alone.

When deciding to outsource, OEMs have to be clear about what to outsource. Some of the key aspects seen over time are;

1. OEMs have to identify their core competency and outsource what is not